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1. Executive Summary

This report answers a deceptively simple question for a prospective Bittensor miner: which subnets give a new entrant a realistic chance to earn rewards, and which one is the best CPU mining target right now? Every figure below is computed from the live chain snapshot captured by the Infranex BT platform at block 9,268,890, with TAO trading at $281.68 and 129 subnets registered on chain. Of those, 124 subnets have active miner emission and were scored. Each subnet was evaluated on four factors: seat availability, reward breadth among registered miners, incentive concentration among the top ten UIDs, and the per-miner share of the daily miner emission pool.

The headline finding is uncomfortable but clarifying: **not a single subnet on the network is simultaneously open-seat and broadly rewarding**. Tier A, the class of subnets where a newcomer can register freely and immediately receive a fair share of emissions, is empty. Roughly 98 of the 124 emitting subnets are either full or whale-dominated, and all ten subnets that do have free seats pay one to four winning miners essentially the entire pool. In practical terms, the era of "register and earn" is over; earning on Bittensor in October 2026 is a displacement game, where a new miner burns registration TAO, takes the seat of the weakest incumbent, and must outperform quickly to keep it.

Within that displacement game, one CPU-only subnet stands out: **SN61 RedTeam**, the only subnet the platform's own opportunity picker rates PRIME. It combines the largest per-miner reward pool of any meritocratic CPU subnet (about $2,206 per average earning miner per month), a healthy 132 rewarded miners, a modest top-10 share of 26 percent, and the longest immunity window on chain at roughly 48 hours. Its realistic new-entrant expectation is approximately $574 per month net after the bond ramp. The recommended strategy is to enter SN61 as the primary target and add the two cheapest meritocratic subnets, SN101 Tag101 and SN83 CliqueAI, on the same machine for a total at-risk registration budget of roughly $80.

0
subnets that are open-seat AND broadly rewarding (Tier A)

124
emitting subnets audited at block 9,268,890

$574
SN61 RedTeam realistic new-entrant EV per month

~$80
total burn budget for the recommended SN61 + SN101 + SN83 trio

2. Market Snapshot and Scoring Methodology

The analysis window is the live chain snapshot taken on October 12, 2026 at 18:23 UTC and published by the Infranex BT chain scanner. At that block the network hosted 129 subnets, of which 120 carry an on-chain identity name and 124 pay miner emissions. Total miner-side emission across those subnets is distributed extremely unevenly: a handful of flagship subnets such as SN5 Hone, SN61 RedTeam and SN120 Affine move tens of TAO per day to miners, while dozens of recently registered subnets emit only fractions of a TAO to a single dominant operator. The table below summarises the market state that the rest of this report reasons from.

Metric	Value
Chain block at snapshot	9,268,890 (live, chain scanner)
TAO price	$281.68
Registered subnets / named / emitting	129 / 120 / 124
Tier A subnets (open + broad rewards)	0
Tier B subnets (open seats, whale lottery)	10
Tier C subnets (full but meritocratic)	16
Tier D subnets (whale-dominated or full)	98
Typical immunity window	7,200 blocks (about 24 hours)

Table 1: Market snapshot at block 9,268,890, October 12, 2026.

Scoring a subnet on "chance to earn" requires different mechanics than scoring it on headline yield. The single most common mistake a new miner makes is reading a subnet's total miner emission, dividing by all registered miners, and assuming that is the reward waiting for them. When only one miner is actually rewarded, that arithmetic produces fantasy numbers such as the $494,766 per month frequently quoted for SN108 ChipForge. This report therefore scores every subnet on four audited factors, each measurable directly from the chain snapshot, and combines them into a 0-100 chance score. The factors are deliberately conservative: a subnet only scores well if a mediocre, non-elite operator can plausibly expect income.

Factor	What it measures	Score weight
Seat availability	Open UIDs (maxUids minus registered miners); full subnets cap the score and require displacement	40 points, or capped when full
Reward breadth	rewardedMiners divided by registered miners; the share of incumbents actually receiving incentive	25 points at 70%+ breadth, 15 at 40%+, 8 at 15%+
Top-10 concentration	top10IncentiveShare; how much of all incentive the ten strongest UIDs absorb	15 points at 50% or less, 8 at 75% or less
Per-miner pool	minerEmissionTaoPerDay divided by rewardedMiners, converted to USD per month	20 points at $600+, 12 at $150+, 6 at $30+
Realizability	rewardRealizability discount when alpha is hard to realise below 0.5	minus 10 points

Table 2: The four-factor earning-chances score and its weights.

Two definitional notes keep later chapters honest. First, "average miner reward" throughout this report means the daily miner emission pool divided by the number of rewarded miners, not by all registered miners, and then converted at the snapshot TAO price; it is the income of a merely typical earner, not of a whale. Second, all subnets discussed as CPU targets were cross-checked against the platform's hardware requirements table so that the recommended rig genuinely meets each subnet's stated needs, which range from plain computation on SN83 to virtualised environments on SN61.

3. The Tier Map: Where New Miners Can Actually Earn

Sorting the 124 emitting subnets into tiers produces the map every registration decision should start from. Tier A, the empty tier, would contain subnets with free seats, broad reward distribution, low concentration and a meaningful per-miner pool; no subnet currently qualifies, which is the single most important fact in this report. Tier B contains the ten subnets with free seats whose rewards are nonetheless captured by one to four miners. Tier C is the practical hunting ground: sixteen full subnets where 200 or more of the 256 registered miners earn something and the top ten UIDs take a minority or modest share. Tier D collects the remaining 98 subnets that are either full and concentrated or dominated by a handful of operators.

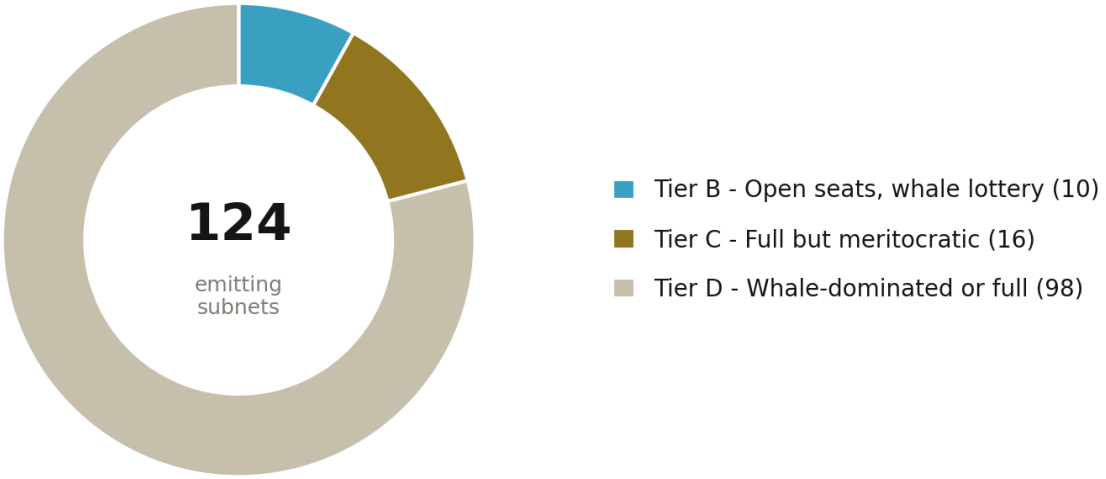


Figure 1: Distribution of the 124 emitting subnets by earning-chances tier. Tier A is omitted because it contains zero subnets.

Tier	Seats	Reward profile	Newcomer guidance
A	Open	Broad and low-concentration	Empty today; nothing to join and earn
B	Open	1-4 winners take ~100% of the pool	Free tryouts, not income; join only to compete
C	Full (256/256)	78-97% of miners earn; top-10 mostly under 45%	Displace the weakest UID; realistic earning path
D	Mostly full	Concentrated or fully saturated	Avoid unless elite in that subnet's niche

Table 3: Tier definitions and the recommended posture toward each.

Because Tier C subnets are full, entry works through Bittensor's displacement mechanic. A newcomer pays the subnet's registration burn, and the chain replaces the lowest-stake UID whose immunity window has expired; the displaced operator loses the seat. The newcomer then has the immunity period, typically 7,200 blocks or about 24 hours, and on the best targets up to 14,400 blocks or about 48 hours, to start earning incentive before becoming the next displacement candidate. The at-risk cost is therefore the burn plus roughly one to two days of effort, which is why the burns listed in Chapter 5, between 0.02 and 0.96 TAO, are the true price of admission tickets.

> *Free seats are free tryouts, not free money: in every open-seat subnet on chain today, one to four incumbents collect essentially the entire miner pool.*

4. Best CPU Pick: SN61 RedTeam

SN61 RedTeam, operated by Innerworks, is a decentralized security-challenge network. Miners run isolated agent environments that attempt offensive and defensive software-engineering tasks posed by validators, and rewards track how well an operator's agents complete those challenges. The workload is pure CPU and memory: there is no GPU requirement anywhere in the subnet's configuration, which makes it unusual among the high-pool subnets on chain and the natural first target for a commodity server build. The platform's opportunity picker scores it PRIME with a conviction of 68, the only PRIME rating on the entire network at snapshot time.

68
picker conviction, the only PRIME pick on chain

$1,061
average established-miner net per month

$574
realistic new-entrant net per month

48 h
immunity window, the longest on chain

Three properties put SN61 ahead of every other CPU subnet. First, its miner pool is the largest among meritocratic CPU targets at about $2,206 per average earning miner per month, spread across 132 rewarded UIDs rather than a handful. Second, its concentration profile is healthy: the top ten UIDs absorb only 26 percent of incentive, so a mid-pack operator earns a meaningful share, and reward realizability is a perfect 1.00 at an alpha price of $0.0116. Third, entry risk is the lowest on chain: the registration burn is just 0.135 TAO (about $38) and the 14,400-block immunity gives a newcomer roughly two days to prove performance, twice the network norm.

Stage	Diligence finding	What it means for entry
s3 - Seats	FULL at 256/256	Entry requires displacing the weakest eligible UID; budget the 0.135 TAO burn as spendable
s4 - Workload	Software-engineering agents	Skill-gated: expect to tune agent tooling; not a passive box
s8 - Validator bond	Bond ramp about 7.9 weeks	Rewards start low and climb; month-1 income realistically $150-250
s9 - Emission trend	History still collecting	Pool size confidence will improve as the scanner accumulates history
s11 - Governance	No trust signals yet	Standard single-team risk; size the position accordingly

Table 4: SN61 diligence stages that did not fully pass, from the platform picker.

The bond ramp deserves emphasis because it dominates cash-flow planning. Bittensor validators bond to miner hotkeys gradually, so a newly displaced-in UID earns a small fraction of the mature rate at first and approaches full weight over roughly eight weeks on SN61. The $574 new-entrant figure already blends this ramp; an operator who survives displacement and reaches mid-pack should converge toward the $1,061 established-miner average. Survival, not registration, is the bottleneck: maintaining agent performance above

the bottom decile is what converts a $38 burn into a recurring income line.

5. CPU Contenders Ranked

Fourteen emitting subnets qualify as meritocratic CPU targets, meaning at least 20 distinct miners receive incentive and the top ten UIDs absorb no more than 75 percent of it. Ranking them by the reward flowing to an average earning miner produces the profile in Figure 2. The spread is wide: SN61 RedTeam pays roughly nine times what SN45 AlphaRidge pays a typical earner, while the middle of the table clusters between $300 and $850 per month. Every subnet in this table is full at 256 of 256 seats, so each entry assumes the displacement mechanic described in Chapter 3 rather than a plain registration.

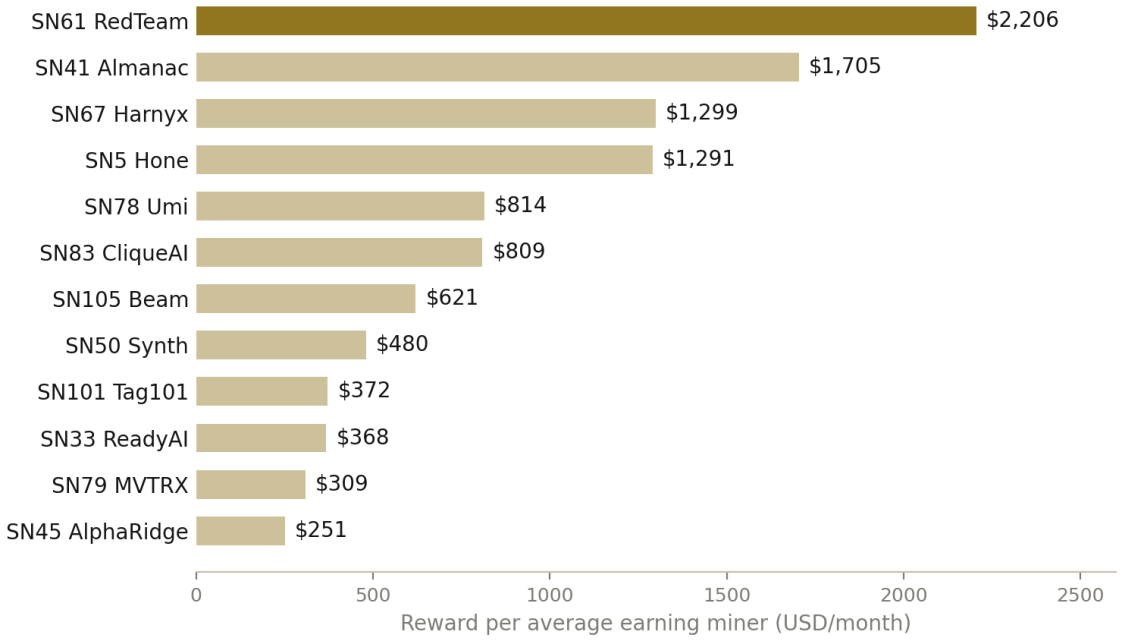


Figure 2: Meritocratic CPU subnets ranked by reward per average earning miner, USD per month at TAO $281.68. SN61 RedTeam is highlighted.

SN	Subnet	Workload	Earn rate	Top-10	Avg $/mo	Burn TAO
61	RedTeam	Security-challenge agents (Innerworks)	52%	26%	$2,206	0.135
41	Almanac	Prediction-market research	42%	64%	$1,705	0.100
67	Harnyx	Deep-research pipelines	46%	72%	$1,299	0.020
5	Hone	RLVR training environments	95%	11%	$1,291	0.958
78	Umi	Motion-to-meaning indexing	42%	58%	$814	0.375
83	CliqueAI	Maximum-clique solver	94%	26%	$809	0.100
105	Beam	Bandwidth sharing	82%	45%	$621	0.022

SN	Subnet	Workload	Earn rate	Top-10	Avg $/mo	Burn TAO
50	Synth	Financial prediction (Mode)	95%	32%	$480	0.800
101	Tag101	Social-post tagging	96%	12%	$372	0.046
33	ReadyAI	Consumer AI content	95%	14%	$368	0.059
79	MVTRX	dTAO exchange infrastructure	97%	24%	$309	0.115
45	AlphaRidge	Market intelligence feeds	94%	60%	$251	0.046

Table 5: Meritocratic CPU subnets. Earn rate = share of registered miners receiving incentive; Avg $/mo = pool divided by rewarded miners.

Two rows deserve special attention beyond the headline. SN5 Hone is the most meritocratic subnet on the entire network: 95 percent of its 256 miners earn and the top ten take only 11 percent, so once admitted its income is the most stable and fair in the table. Its obstacle is purely the entry ticket, 0.958 TAO or roughly $270, the price of a subnet whose seats rarely churn. At the opposite end, SN41 Almanac and SN67 Harnyx post attractive averages but concentrate 58 to 72 percent of incentive in ten UIDs; their averages describe elite operators far better than a newcomer, and both belong in the specialist pile rather than a starter portfolio.

For the same machine, the pragmatic add-ons are the three cheapest admissions: SN101 Tag101 at 0.046 TAO, SN33 ReadyAI at 0.059 TAO and SN83 CliqueAI at 0.100 TAO. Their workloads are light enough to coexist with an SN61 agent environment on one 64 GB box, and each carries an earn rate above 90 percent, so a seat, once taken, is likely to keep paying. SN105 Beam is the cheapest experiment on the list at 0.022 TAO, but its bandwidth-sharing profile suits a well-connected home server better than a data-center VM.

6. Whale-Lottery Traps to Avoid

The most expensive mistake available to a new miner is treating an open seat as an invitation. All ten Tier B subnets have free capacity, and every one of them routes effectively the whole miner pool to between one and four rewarded operators. Registering into such a subnet converts a small burn into a zero-income seat that either displaces a real earner elsewhere or idles. The table below lists the six traps with the largest headline numbers, precisely because those headlines are what sucker unfamiliar miners in; the final column shows what the arithmetic actually describes.

SN	Subnet	Seats open	Rewarded	Headline $/mo	What the number really is
108	ChipForge	100 of 256	1 of 155	$494.8k	One operator's take; newcomers earn zero
90	KubeTEE	100 of 256	2 of 100	$238.4k	Two-operator cartel pool
122	CookingTAO	174 of 256	2 of 82	$74.0k	Four-way split at best
117	everyframe	124 of 256	1 of 132	$69.2k	Single-winner CPU lottery

SN	Subnet	Seats open	Rewarded	Headline $/mo	What the number really is
35	SN35	251 of 256	1 of 5	$43.9k	Single-winner subnet, see below
47	GPUForge	158 of 256	1 of 158	$43.1k	One H100 operator collects all

Table 6: Open-seat subnets whose headline yields are single-winner pools.

6.1 Case study: SN35 and the NO-GO verdict

SN35 illustrates the pattern perfectly because it was the subnet this audit was originally asked about. Its five registered miners share a pool of 5.2 TAO per day, and exactly one of them is rewarded: the median rewarded miner's incentive share is 100 percent of the pool. The $8,552 gross monthly figure shown on the platform profitability card is therefore not a forecast of what a joining miner earns; it is the current income of the single incumbent. The platform's NO-GO verdict is correct for a standard operator: unless you have concrete reason to believe you can beat that one UID on its own evaluation metric, the honest expected value of registering is the burn cost times zero.

The general detection rule is mechanical and worth memorising: when **rewardedMiners is four or fewer while top10IncentiveShare sits at or near 100 percent**, the subnet is a lottery, regardless of how large its pool appears in marketing threads or dashboards. Both numbers come straight from the chain snapshot, so the check takes seconds in the Infranex playbook view. As a class, Tier B is worth monitoring rather than mining: the moment a lottery subnet widens its reward distribution, for example after a mechanism change, it graduates toward Tier A, and its free seats become genuinely valuable. Chapter 8 returns to that watcher.

7. Recommended Action Plan

The plan below turns the ranking into three concrete phases for one CPU machine. It assumes no existing hardware; if a capable box is already running, Phase 1 collapses to a software setup afternoon. All burns are treated as spendable marketing budget, not investments, because displacement entry can fail, and the portfolio is sized so that total worst-case loss across all three subnets is roughly the price of a restaurant dinner.

Component	Specification	Notes
CPU	AMD Ryzen 9 or EPYC, 16-32 cores	SN61 agents and SN83 solver both scale with cores
Memory	64-128 GB ECC	Isolated environments per subnet; 64 GB is the floor
Storage	1-2 TB NVMe	Chain sync plus container images
Network	Stable 100 Mbps+	SN105 Beam becomes viable only with a good line
Power	150-200 W typical draw	About $12 per month at $0.10 per kWh
Capex (used market)	About $1,500-2,500	Skip entirely if repurposing an existing server

Table 7: Recommended single-box specification for the CPU trio.

Target	Burn (TAO)	Burn (USD)	Role in portfolio
SN61 RedTeam	0.135	~$38	Primary income engine; longest immunity, largest pool
SN101 Tag101	0.046	~$13	Light tagging worker; 96% earn rate keeps the seat paid
SN83 CliqueAI	0.100	~$28	CPU solver; stable mid-pack income
Total	0.281	~$79	All three on one machine

Table 8: Entry budget. Burns are at-risk, one-time registration costs.

Phase 1, days one and two: provision the box, register into SN61 by displacing the weakest eligible UID, and ship a baseline agent so incentive starts flowing inside the 48-hour immunity window. Phase 2, weeks two and three: once SN61 is stable, take SN101 and SN83 seats on the same machine and automate seat-health checks so a dipping UID is repaired before it becomes a displacement target. Phase 3, weeks eight and nine: after the SN61 bond ramp matures, review per-subnet income against the table below and rebalance, either deepening SN61 tooling or rotating a losing seat into the next best entry from Chapter 5.

Period	Expected net per month	Basis
Month 1	$150-250	SN61 bond ramp plus SN101 and SN83 starting from zero
Months 2-3	$500-800	Ramp roughly half complete; all three seats earning
Steady state	$700-1,100	SN61 at $574-1,061, SN101 at $200-372, SN83 at $300-500

Table 9: Blended expectation for the trio, assuming seats are held.

8. Monitoring and Re-Running the Analysis

Chain conditions move daily: seats churn, pools rebalance after mechanism changes, and new fair-launch subnets appear with genuinely broad emissions. Every number in this report is reproducible on the platform host with the two analysis scripts persisted there, so the audit can be refreshed in under a minute at any time.

```
cd /home/z/my-project
INFRANEX_WORKERS=off bun --smol scripts/earn-chances.ts # tier map refresh
INFRANEX_WORKERS=off bun --smol scripts/best-subnets-now.ts # picker
verdicts
```

Three signals deserve standing attention. First, any Tier C subnet shedding multiple seats at once is the cheapest entry the market ever offers, because weak incumbents are leaving and displacement risk collapses. Second, a Tier B lottery subnet that widens its rewarded set, visible as rewardedMiners jumping from single digits into double digits, graduates toward Tier A and converts its free seats into real income slots. Third, SN61's own incentive trend after the bond ramp confirms or revises the $574 new-entrant expectation used throughout this report. Wiring these three checks into the platform's watcher so that seat openings and reward-breadth shifts raise an alert is the recommended follow-up, and it turns this one-time audit into a standing edge.